STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-7210
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **04/22/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT EXPOSURE TO BODILY FLUIDS	CROSS REFERENCE G-7200 JOB RELATED INJURIES G-7500 UNIVERSAL PRECAUTIONS/INFECTIOUS DISEASE CONTROL			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for reporting exposure to bodily fluids incidents and the process for medical follow-up.

II. Policy:

Employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall report all significant incidents of exposure to bodily fluids while on duty. The Office Manager and Medical Unit shall oversee the process and ensure proper reporting and follow-up care. To limit the amount of exposure to bodily fluids, employees shall adhere to all universal precautions (see G-7500 Universal Precautions/Infectious Disease Control).

III. Definitions:

A. BODILY FLUIDS: Fluids that have been recognized by the Center for Disease Control (CDC) as directly linked to the transmission of blood borne pathogens and to which universal precautions apply. These fluids include blood, semen, blood products, vaginal secretions, cerebrospinal fluid, synovial fluid, and amniotic fluid. For purposes of this policy, bodily fluids shall also include saliva, urine, vomitus, and fecal matter.

B. BLOOD BORNE PATHOGENS: Pathogenic microorganisms that are present in human blood and can cause disease in humans. These pathogens include, but are not limited to, Hepatitis B Virus (HBV) and Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV).

C. EXPOSURE INCIDENT: For the purposes of this policy, exposure shall mean the introduction of any bodily fluid into any open wound, skin or mucous membrane. Exposures include needle-sticks, vomit, blood, or saliva in the mouth, eyes, or open wounds, bites, etc.

IV. Procedures:

A. Reporting Exposure Incidents: In the event an employee of the Sheriff's Office is exposed to bodily fluids from an inmate or other person during the course of his or her duties, he or she shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. The employee shall immediately report the incident to his or her supervisor.

2. If there is a question as to whether an exposure occurred, a medical facility may be contacted. The Medical facility shall provide direction and, if necessary, meet the employee to conduct an evaluation.

3. If the individual causing the exposure is injured and requires medical attention, the employee shall report to the same medical facility as the individual. The exposed employee shall notify the medical personnel that he or she was exposed to bodily fluids of the injured person.

4. Should the employee be injured during the exposure incident, the job-related injury procedures should be followed (see G-7200 Job Related Injuries).

5. If the employee is exposed within a Sheriff's Office facility (e.g., juvenile justice center), he or she shall immediately report the incident to the Medical Unit or respond to a medical facility. If reported to the Medical Unit, they shall complete an immediate evaluation. If no medical personnel are on duty, the employee may report to a medical facility.

6. The exposed employee shall obtain a report number and complete the following:

a) Information report.
b) First Report of Alleged Occupational Injury or Illness form.
c) Exposure Incident Report form.

7. In the event of incapacitation, the employee's supervisor shall be responsible for the completion of all reports and forms and shall submit them for the exposed employee.

8. All forms and reports shall be forwarded to the Office Manager.

B. Exposure Incident Follow-up:

1. The exposed employee's supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or ADC of the incident.

2. The exposed employees' supervisor shall contact the person responsible for the exposure and request he or she submit to a blood draw (unless the person has already submitted as a result of medical treatment).

a) If the person responsible for the exposure voluntarily submits to a blood draw, the supervisor shall transport the individual to the nearest medical facility or the facility where the employee is treated, if applicable.

b) If the person refuses, the supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or ADC and a court order shall be obtained.

3. The Office Manager shall review and forward the required documentation to NIRMA.

4. Follow-up laboratory work and reporting of the exposure incident shall be referred to and coordinated by the Office Manager.